# FORMAL SUBMISSION

## *TRH 26-11 / TRE 26-09 | Santa Anita LA28 cross-country course*

| | |
|---|---|
| **CLASSIFICATION** | Formal permit objection, request to withhold action, administrative-record submission, and notice of unresolved evidentiary defects. |
| **EXHIBIT A** | Zero-Removal First: Santa Anita / LA28, 21 pages, issued 29 August 2026. |
| **FILE CONTROL** | SHA-256: e4f8470e35dbcf2215832932ce90775288 1dd9bae232116d001ab79c468ba487 |

### NOTICE TO THE DECISION, RECORDS, LEGAL, AND APPELLATE CHAIN

| | |
|---|---|
| Lisa Flores, Development Services Director | Paul P. Cheng, Mayor |
| Fiona Graham, Planning Services Manager | David Fu, Mayor Pro Tem |
| Linda Rodriguez, City Clerk | Michael Cao, Council Member |
| Dominic Lazzaretto, City Manager | Sharon Kwan, Council Member |
| Michael J. Maurer, City Attorney, through City Clerk | John Han, Council Member |

### SUBJECT Formal objection, demand to withhold action, and submission of zero-removal alternatives memorandum

| | |
|---|---|
| **ACTION REQUESTED** | Keep both permits pending; restore the complete technical record; publish and independently test the alternatives required by Arcadia's code; disclose the permanent residual, replacement findings, and public-access terms; and provide a consolidated written response before action. |

Mayor Cheng, Mayor Pro Tem Fu, Council Members Cao, Kwan, and Han, Director Flores, Manager Graham, City Manager Lazzaretto, City Clerk Rodriguez, and City Attorney Maurer through the City Clerk:

This message is a formal written objection to approval of TRH 26-11 and TRE 26-09 on the present record, a request that the City withhold action until the evidentiary defects identified below are cured, and a submission for inclusion in the complete administrative record for both permits and every related environmental, grading, Olympic-delivery, or appellate proceeding. Attached as Exhibit A is Zero-Removal First: Santa Anita / LA28, a 21-page administrative alternatives memorandum issued 29 August 2026. Please preserve this message with its headers and attachment as received, circulate it to every City employee, consultant, reviewing official, and legal adviser participating in the permits, and confirm by 5:00 p.m. on Wednesday, September 2, 2026 that it has been entered into the project file. Exhibit A SHA-256: e4f8470e35dbcf2215832932ce90775288 1dd9bae232116d001ab79c468ba487.

I am past the stage of requesting general assurances that safety, trees, and community concerns have been considered. The City is reviewing an application to remove 34 protected oaks, plant 34 replacement trees, and authorize construction or course activity within the protected zones of 45 additional oaks. Arcadia Municipal Code section 9110.01.070 requires the healthy-tree record to explain why removal is necessary and why removal is more desirable than alternative project designs. The same section requires an equivalent necessity and alternatives explanation for protected-zone encroachment. The legal object is therefore specific. The applicant must demonstrate why this selected geometry defeats reasonably feasible lower-impact designs under disclosed mandatory criteria.

The public record presently does not permit that determination. As of 29 August 2026, the City project page links to the course map, arborist assessment, biological resources assessment, precise grading plan, and rough grading plan, but each of those five links returns a 404 error. The permit remains listed as pending. The public therefore cannot inspect the selected route, surveyed tree locations and protected zones, grading, drainage, utilities, construction limits, or the technical basis for the proposed impacts. A comment or decision clock should not run against a record that the City itself has made unavailable. The files should be restored, completeness should be disclosed, and a meaningful review period should begin only after the complete technical record is accessible.

The only publicly reported alternatives claim is that an earlier route affected more trees and was modified. That statement establishes that the course geometry is adjustable. It does not establish that the current route is necessary, that it is the least damaging reasonably feasible route, or that a route designed from the outset around immutable protected-tree exclusions was ever tested. Exhibit A supplies a falsifiable study protocol, identified as ZR-1, that imports the actual survey, grading, drainage, utilities, safety, welfare, access, and sporting criteria and then attempts to route the course through Santa Anita's existing tracks, turf, infield arenas, open event areas, parking hardscape, service corridors, stabling, veterinary capacity, and temporary-overlay systems without removal. ZR-1 is not represented as a finished civil design or FEI certification. Its purpose is to require the applicant to test the available site capacity rather than treating the preferred course line as the fixed constraint.

That study is proportionate to the site. The FEI describes Santa Anita as a 320-acre equestrian facility with a 26,000-seat grandstand, an infield capable of accommodating 50,000 people, 61 barns for more than 2,000 horses, and an on-course veterinary clinic. Santa Anita has separately installed major show arenas and schooling infrastructure in the infield, used the north parking lot for temporary stabling, and described those investments as part of a strategy to create a world-class equestrian venue. A property of that scale may still present genuine Olympic cross-country constraints, but those constraints must be demonstrated with maps, measurements, standards, and alternative comparisons. They cannot be presumed from the selected design.

The permanent residual makes the record more demanding. Santa Anita's vice president of equestrian operations stated publicly that the cross-country course will remain after the Games and will permit Santa Anita to invite additional forms of horse sport. The City is therefore considering irreversible environmental authorization that would also expand a privately controlled operating platform after 2028.

The record should identify the complete capital stack; distinguish temporary overlay, permanent Olympic-triggered work, and private elective enhancement; state who pays for and owns each retained improvement; disclose useful life, maintenance, restoration, scheduling, and commercial rights; and identify any enforceable public-access consideration received by Arcadia.

I have located no published easement, trail dedication, public-use covenant, bicycle right, family walking right, or recurring free-access schedule attached to this permanent course. Santa Anita's current visitor rules prohibit bicycles inside the park. The City should answer the practical public-benefit question in writing: after the Games leave and the course remains, may an Arcadia resident enter the improved area with children for an ordinary walk, ride a bicycle through it, or use it without admission to a privately programmed event? If the answer depends entirely on Santa Anita's continuing permission, the record should describe the residual accurately as a privately controlled asset rather than imply a public recreational right that has not been created.

The replacement proposal also requires an express finding. Arcadia's default rule is at least two new 24-inch-box trees for every protected tree approved for removal, subject to the Director's power to modify that requirement when appropriate. Thirty-four removals begin from a default of 68 replacement trees, while the project page identifies 34. The City should disclose whether a reduction has been requested or proposed, identify the official exercising modification authority, and publish the written basis, species, locations, establishment obligations, mortality security, maintenance responsibility, and time required to approach the canopy and habitat functions lost at removal.

LA28's own public materials describe a no-permanent-build or no-new-permanent-venues delivery model based on existing venues, temporary facilities, and temporary overlays. Santa Anita is an existing venue, but that does not answer how new grading, drainage, footing, road, utility, landscape, or course work retained after 2028 is classified. The permit record should provide component-level accounting so that permanent Olympic-triggered work does not disappear inside the general description of an existing venue.

Exhibit A maps the relevant actors, authority, site capacity, residual value, Arcadia-wide land-use context, technical study, and records schedule. It deliberately does not allege corruption, does not depend on a hidden-development theory, and does not assert a Trammell Crow connection to these permits without documentary evidence. Those exclusions are intentional. They leave the City with a direct administrative question that cannot be answered by disputing motive, tone, or politics. A responsive answer must identify the document, criterion, official, analysis, and finding that supports the proposed action.

Before either permit is decided, please provide one consolidated written response stating whether the City will keep both permits pending; the date each application was deemed complete and the resulting decision deadline; the date on which all five technical files will be restored; whether the applicant submitted a comparative alternatives analysis and where it can be reviewed; whether a zero-removal or tree-exclusion design was tested, by whom, and under what criteria; the mandatory tree-specific conflict asserted for each proposed removal and encroachment; the proposed replacement ratio and findings supporting any reduction from 68; the temporary and permanent project components, their funding and post-Games ownership; every binding public-access right created by the project; the environmental-review status; the identity of the initial decision-maker; the form and date of formal notice; and the applicable appeal deadline.

The City can acknowledge this filing by producing a reviewable record rather than convening another community presentation. If the City proceeds without a written response, the administrative record will show that these specific defects were identified while the permits were pending, that a concrete and technically testable lower-impact study was supplied, that the City's own principal technical links were inaccessible, and that no written answer was provided before action. Any nonresponse will be recorded only as notice without a written answer, not as agreement.

Please also preserve all responsive records, including superseded alignments, geospatial files, native plans, tree data, grading and drainage files, decision logs, safety and welfare criteria, emails and attachments, meeting records, funding and ownership agreements, legacy and access terms, replacement-tree analyses, environmental-review records, and communications with Santa Anita Park, 1/ST, LA28, FEI, course-design personnel, engineers, arborists, biologists, contractors, and consultants. A companion California Public Records Act request is being submitted separately through the City's designated records channel so that the disclosure track is assigned its own number and statutory determination.

The controlling question is this: what mandatory, disclosed, and independently verified technical requirement makes removal of these 34 protected oaks and encroachment upon 45 additional protected zones more desirable than a tested zero-removal route using Santa Anita's extensive existing site capacity, and what enforceable public right does Arcadia receive for the permanent privately controlled residual its permits would authorize?

*Respectfully,*

Jonathan Sandhu
jvssandhu@gmail.com
Interested person

**Record note.** All factual propositions, source links, evidentiary qualifications, technical study gates, actor roles, and records categories are documented in Exhibit A. The companion California Public Records Act request is filed separately so the statutory disclosure track receives its own tracking number and determination.




# An Evidence and Design Memorandum on the Proposed LA28 Cross-Country Course at Santa Anita Park

*Why Arcadia should withhold TRH 26-11 and TRE 26-09 until a hardscape-first alternative is independently tested, disclosed, and compared*

| | |
|---|---|
| **CLASSIFICATION** | Administrative alternatives memorandum and preliminary design brief. Not a civil design or FEI certification. |
| **ISSUED** | Prepared for public circulation and technical review \| 29 August 2026 |

*Prepared from the public record available through 29 August 2026. All design geometry is conceptual unless expressly identified as a published facility dimension.*

DECISION MEMORANDUM

# The decision Arcadia should make now

**RECOMMENDED DISPOSITION**

Keep TRH 26-11 and TRE 26-09 pending. Restore public access to the technical record. Require Santa Anita Park, LA28, and the FEI design team to complete and publish a formal zero-removal feasibility study that treats every surveyed protected-tree zone as an immutable exclusion layer. Submit that study to independent civil, arboricultural, veterinary, access, and sporting review before any finding that removal is necessary or more desirable than alternative project designs.

The City of Arcadia is reviewing a request to remove 34 protected oak trees, plant 34 replacements, and permit construction or course encroachment within the protected zones of 45 additional oaks for the proposed LA28 eventing cross-country course at Santa Anita Park. Arcadia's own healthy-tree standard requires an explanation of why removal is necessary and why removal is more desirable than alternative project designs. The corresponding encroachment standard asks the same comparative question. [1, 2, 3]

The current public presentation does not establish that comparison. It identifies the selected proposal and, according to a meeting statement, an earlier proposal that affected more trees. Showing that one discarded alignment was worse does not establish that the selected alignment is the least damaging reasonably feasible design. The controlling comparison is between the selected alignment and every materially different lower-impact alternative, including a route that imports surveyed trunks and protected zones as fixed no-go geometry and uses Santa Anita's extensive existing tracks, turf, infield arenas, open event areas, parking hardscape, stabling, veterinary resources, and temporary-overlay capacity. [4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10]

This memorandum advances ZR-1, a hardscape-first, tree-exclusion feasibility hypothesis. ZR-1 is deliberately falsifiable. It does not claim to be a surveyed grading plan, a finished civil design, or an FEI-certified Olympic course. It identifies the available site capacity, specifies the records and technical criteria that must be imported, and states the validation gates necessary to prove or disprove a zero-removal route. The burden is not on residents to design an Olympic venue from incomplete public files. The burden is on the applicant and regulator to show, with disclosed evidence, why protected-tree removal beats redesign.

The residual value also matters. Santa Anita has publicly said the course will remain after the Games and will allow the property to host additional kinds of horse sport. That statement converts the proposal from a purely temporary event overlay into a permit for infrastructure that expands a privately controlled operating platform after 2028. The record should therefore disclose funding, useful life, permanent works, ownership, maintenance, restoration, commercial use, scheduling rights, and any enforceable public-access benefit. [4, 6]

## Requested findings and actions

| | |
|---|---|
| 1 | **No present necessity finding**<br>The record should not support removal until every lower-impact alternative is compared under disclosed mandatory criteria. |
| 2 | **Zero-removal study**<br>The applicant should prepare ZR-1 and other tree-exclusion variants using surveyed tree polygons, grading, drainage, utilities, course criteria, operational constraints, and temporary-overlay capabilities. |
| 3 | **Tree-specific conflict matrix**<br>Each proposed removal or encroachment should be tied to a mandatory technical requirement, attempted redesigns, residual conflict, and independent reviewer. |
| 4 | **Residual-asset disclosure**<br>The parties should disclose who pays, what remains, who owns it after the Games, how it will be used, and whether Arcadia receives any binding public access. |
| 5 | **Meaningful public review**<br>Restored and complete files should be published with sufficient time for technical review before a decision or appeal clock begins. |

EVIDENTIARY CONTROL

# Evidence ledger

This paper is designed for an administrative record, an appeal, and public scrutiny. Its claims are separated into verified facts, reasonable design inferences, and unresolved questions. The ledger below states the evidentiary posture once so that the analysis can proceed without repeatedly diluting each paragraph with the same caveat.

| Ledger field | Position |
|---|---|
| **Evidence tier** | Primary reliance on City of Arcadia, LA28, FEI, Santa Anita/f/ST, U.S. Census Bureau, and California statutory sources. ABC7 is used only for attributed statements made at the 27 August 2026 meeting. |
| **Venue** | TRH 26-11 and TRE 26-09 administrative record, any appeal to the Planning Commission or City Council, California Public Records Act process, and public or press review. |
| **Target** | Defer permit action and require a formal zero-removal feasibility study, independent review, a complete alternatives record, and residual-asset disclosure. |
| **Upside** | The argument is factual, falsifiable, and anchored to Arcadia's own comparative standard rather than to motive allegations. |
| **Downside** | On 29 August 2026, the City page linked to a course map, arborist report, biological report, precise grading plan, and rough grading plan, but each link returned a 404 error during this review. Exact tree locations, species, condition, protected zones, grades, drainage, and utilities therefore could not be independently assessed from those links. [1] |
| **Failure mode** | Treating ZR-1 as a finished Olympic course would overstate the evidence. ZR-1 is a study hypothesis whose purpose is to force the applicant to test the available site capacity against the real technical record. |

**RECORD-ACCESS DEFECT**

The failure of five linked technical files does not prove that the underlying documents do not exist. It does mean the public could not use the City's current project page to inspect the most important plan, arboricultural, biological, and grading materials when this memorandum was prepared. The proper remedy is prompt restoration and a review period measured from complete publication, not from the date of a broken-link notice.

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SECTION 1

# The administrative object and governing comparison

The object before Arcadia is a pair of protected-tree permits. TRH 26-11 seeks authorization to remove 34 protected oaks associated with the proposed cross-country course. TRE 26-09 seeks authorization for improvements and course activity within the protected zones of 45 additional oaks. The City page also identifies 34 new trees. [1] The regulatory question is therefore narrower and more disciplined than a referendum on the Olympics. Arcadia must decide whether the applicant has carried the burden imposed by its tree-preservation regime for these specific removals and encroachments.

Arcadia treats protected trees as significant ecological and aesthetic resources for present and future residents. A healthy-tree application must explain why removal is necessary, why removal is more desirable than alternative project designs, and what mitigation is proposed. The regulations apply a comparable alternatives inquiry to protected-zone encroachments. They also define protected zones broadly enough to capture grading, hardscape, parking, construction, storage, and other activity that can affect roots, and set a minimum zone of 15 feet from the trunk while requiring inclusion of known root structure. [2, 3]

Those provisions establish a design hierarchy. The project should first move around the protected resource. Removal becomes a candidate only after the applicant has identified feasible alternatives, applied disclosed criteria consistently, and demonstrated why redesign does not solve the conflict. A preferred route, a faster construction schedule, a more convenient broadcast plan, or a more commercially useful post-Games course may be relevant project considerations, but none becomes a necessity finding simply by being included in the chosen design.

## The comparison cannot stop at one earlier, worse route

Santa Anita's vice president of equestrian operations stated that an earlier course affected more trees and was modified to reduce environmental impact while preserving safety. [4] That statement is useful because it confirms that the course geometry is adjustable. It does not establish that the present alignment is the least damaging feasible option. The relevant denominator is not "the selected route compared with the worst route previously considered." The relevant denominator is the full field of reasonably feasible alternatives, including routes designed from the outset with protected trees treated as immutable exclusions.

A credible alternatives record should present materially different alignments side by side. Each should show route geometry, surveyed tree and protected-zone impacts, grades, drainage, footing transitions, obstacle logic, emergency and veterinary access, operational effects, broadcast and spectator constraints, cost, schedule, temporary and permanent works, and post-Games use. Each rejection should identify the mandatory criterion that caused it. Without that comparison, the City cannot distinguish true sporting or safety constraints from accumulated preferences.

> **CONTROL QUESTION**
>
> What competent evidence demonstrates that removal of these 34 protected oaks, and encroachment upon 45 more protected zones, is necessary and more desirable than every reasonably feasible lower-impact design?

SECTION 2

# What the public record proves, and what it does not

| Record status | Proposition |
|---|---|
| **Verified** | TRH 26-11 seeks 34 protected-oak removals; TRE 26-09 concerns 45 protected-zone encroachments; the project page identifies 34 replacement trees. [1] |
| **Verified** | Arcadia requires necessity and a comparison against alternative project designs for healthy-tree removal. [2, 3] |
| **Verified** | Santa Anita says an earlier design affected more trees and the course was modified. [4] |
| **Verified** | LA28 said after the meeting that the best path forward had not yet been selected. [4] |
| **Verified** | Santa Anita says the course will remain after 2028 and support additional horse sport. [4] |
| **Verified** | Santa Anita is a 320-acre equestrian facility with extensive racing, stabling, veterinary, event, arena, and parking capacity. [5, 6, 8, 9, 10] |
| **Not established** | That the present alignment is the least damaging reasonably feasible alternative. |

| Record status | Proposition |
|---|---|
| **Not established** | That each proposed removal or encroachment is compelled by a mandatory FEI, LA28, welfare, emergency, civil, or access requirement. |
| **Not established** | The funding, ownership, useful life, maintenance, commercial use, and public-access terms for the permanent residual course. |
| **Not established** | That 34 young replacements provide temporal or functional equivalence to the mature trees removed. |

The distinction between what is verified and what remains unproved is strategically important. A campaign built around hidden motives or named developers without a documentary nexus gives the decision-maker a factual escape. The administrative defect is already sufficient: the public has not been shown the comparative evidence Arcadia's own rule calls for, while the project produces a permanent operating benefit for the private venue owner.

### No verified Trammell Crow nexus to these permits

Trammell Crow Residential and other developers are active in Arcadia's broader housing and entitlement landscape, including large transit-adjacent projects. That context matters to the City's general land-use workload and political economy. This review found no verified evidence that Trammell Crow is the applicant, contractor, funder, property owner, or decision-maker for TRH 26-11, TRE 26-09, or the Santa Anita cross-country course. The named project actors are Santa Anita/1/ST, LA28, the FEI design apparatus, and the City of Arcadia. The paper therefore excludes a Trammell Crow theory from the permit argument unless later records establish one.

The same discipline applies to allegations of corruption or predetermined approval. It is reasonable to predict that the institutional preference may favor Games delivery, but a useful filing should convert that prediction into testable procedure. The question is whether the City will publish the evidence, require a zero-removal study, make tree-specific findings, and preserve a meaningful appeal record. Those are observable acts.

SECTION 3

## Site capacity: why a zero-removal study is reasonable

Santa Anita is not a constrained neighborhood parcel. FEI describes a 320-acre facility with a 1,100-foot grandstand seating 26,000, an infield capable of accommodating 50,000 people, 61 barns for more than 2,000 horses, and an on-course veterinary clinic. [5] Santa Anita separately advertises more than one million square feet of flexible indoor and outdoor event space and describes its vast parking lots as a core filming and event asset. [9, 10] These facts do not prove that every acre is usable for Olympic cross-country. They do establish a level of site capacity that makes a tree-exclusion design study rational and proportionate.

The property has also received recent equestrian capital investment. In 2024, 1/ST installed three major infield show arenas: a 150 by 300 foot main arena, a secondary arena totaling almost 140,000 square feet, and a 125 by 250 foot schooling arena. The same announcement stated that temporary stabling would be placed in the north parking lot and described the investment as part of a strategy to transform the infield into a world-class equestrian venue. [6] Santa Anita also completed an $8 million, six-furlong Tapeta training oval to complement its one-mile main dirt track. [8]

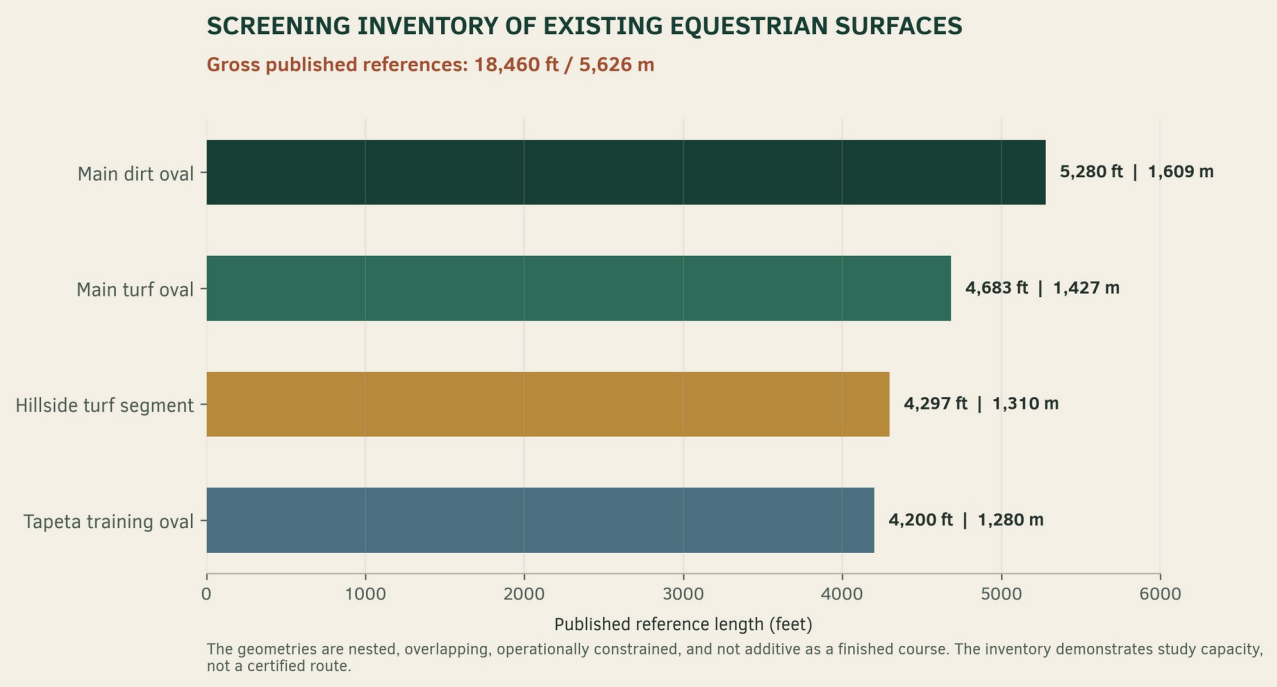



**FIGURE 1.** *Published screening inventory of existing track, turf, and training surfaces. The lengths overlap and cannot simply be added into a certified route; they show that the site contains multiple large equestrian geometries that should be examined before protected trees are treated as the movable constraint.* Sources: Santa Anita media guide and official Tapeta announcement. [7, 8]

Published facility dimensions yield a gross screening inventory of approximately 18,460 feet, or 5,626 meters, across the main dirt oval, main turf oval, hillside turf segment, and Tapeta training oval. The number is intentionally labeled gross. These surfaces are nested, may operate under different footing and racing constraints, and cannot be treated as four freely available linear segments. Its value is diagnostic: the site contains enough existing equestrian geometry that a formal route-synthesis exercise should precede a conclusion that 34 protected trees must be removed.

### Capacity is a reason to study, not a substitute for study

Aerial observation and published dimensions can establish plausibility. They cannot resolve grade, drainage, turning radius, speed profile, fence sequencing, footing transitions, emergency corridors, sightlines, spectator separation, broadcast positions, utility conflicts, or racing operations. ZR-1 therefore uses the site inventory only to define the burden of inquiry. The applicant has the surveys, design criteria, consultants, and operating information necessary to perform the actual test.

This is an important allocation of responsibility. Residents should not be told that they must produce a certified Olympic course before asking the applicant to redesign. A resident can identify an obvious capacity question. The regulated actor must then demonstrate, with the technical record it controls, why the capacity cannot be converted into a compliant lower-impact alternative.

SECTION 4

## ZR-1: hardscape-first, tree-exclusion feasibility hypothesis

ZR-1 classifies the design problem as a constrained route-synthesis exercise. Its first input is not the preferred course line. Its first input is the surveyed exclusion layer: every protected trunk, known root structure, and legally defined protected zone. That geometry is treated as fixed. The route, obstacles, temporary surfaces, access plans, and spectator functions must move around it unless the study demonstrates that a specific mandatory criterion cannot be satisfied.

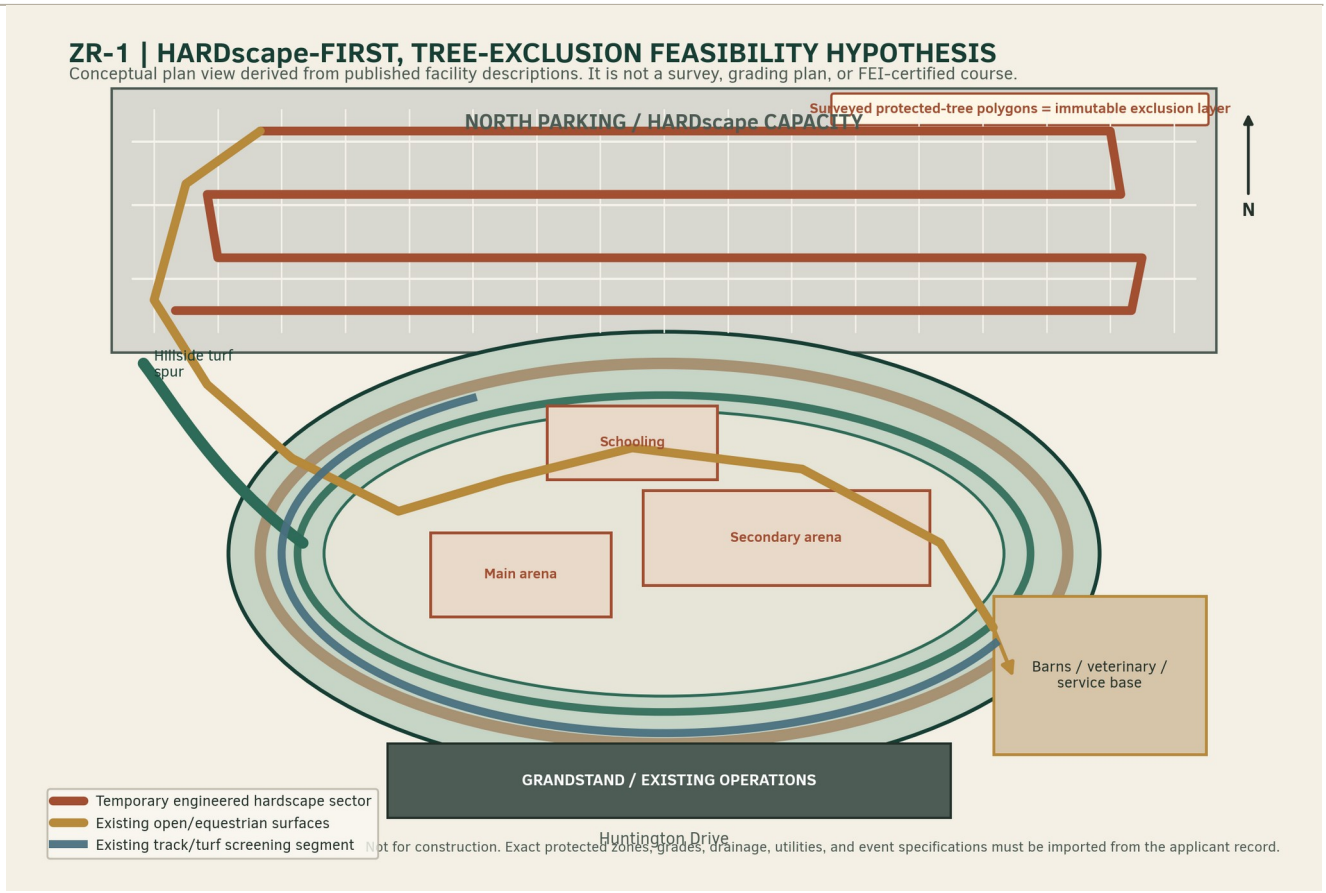



**FIGURE 2.** *ZR-1 conceptual site-capacity schematic. The north parking area is screened for engineered temporary footing and serpentine distance; existing infield, turf, track, stable, veterinary, and service assets are integrated subject to survey and operational validation. The drawing is not for construction and does not depict the actual protected-tree polygons.*

## Sector A: north parking and hardscape capacity

The north parking field should be evaluated as a temporary engineered competition sector rather than as background land available for permanent grading. Santa Anita has already described temporary north-lot stabling for major horse shows. [6] LA28 has built its venue-delivery model around temporary overlays, ground protection, rental equipment, and adaptation of existing facilities. [12, 13] A zero-removal study should therefore test removable footing assemblies, geocell or panel systems, modular topography, portable obstacles, temporary drainage capture, protected crossings, and post-event restoration on selected hardscape lanes.

A serpentine or folded geometry can create substantial course distance within a broad parking field without requiring a permanent single-loop landscape. The design team should model approach lines, speed control, turning radii, horse sightlines, obstacle spacing, heat, glare, dust, drainage, and emergency bypasses. If a hardscape sector fails, the report should identify the measured failure and the mitigation tested, rather than rejecting the concept through a general assertion that cross-country "needs grass."

## Sector B: infield arenas and open equestrian surfaces

The infield now contains purpose-built all-weather equestrian arenas and open areas that Santa Anita says retain flexibility for family events during racing season. [6] ZR-1 would test whether portions of these surfaces can host start, finish, warm-up, technical combinations, controlled speed sectors, media zones, or other functions that reduce pressure on tree-bearing ground. The study must preserve the separate integrity of jumping and dressage programs, horse circulation, stabling access, and track operations.

## Sector C: selected track, turf, and hillside segments

Existing track and turf geometries should be treated as screening candidates, not assumed solutions. The main turf and hillside turf can offer natural grades and long sightlines, while the dirt and Tapeta ovals provide engineered surfaces and known maintenance systems. [7, 8] The design team should test only those segments compatible with horse welfare, racing schedules,

footing transitions, rail and barrier requirements, track restoration, and the sporting character of eventing. A zero-removal course may use some, all, or none of these segments; the point is to test them in a controlled matrix.

### Sector D: transition, service, emergency, and broadcast corridors

A credible alternative must work as an event system. It must reserve veterinary routes, horse ambulances, emergency vehicles, track maintenance, broadcast compounds, athlete circulation, spectator separation, accessible paths, workforce movement, and secure service access. These functions should be mapped before the course line is finalized. When operational functions are treated as movable overlay elements, they can often be consolidated on existing pavement rather than scattered into root zones.

> **FALSIFICATION STANDARD**
> ZR-1 should be rejected only through a written record identifying the specific mandatory criteria it cannot satisfy after reasonable mitigation, the data used, the alternatives tested, and the independent reviewers who concur. "Safety," "Olympic requirements," or "course quality" without a traceable criterion is not a falsification.

SECTION 5

## Technical validation protocol

A zero-removal alternative must be subjected to the same level of scrutiny as the selected course. The validation sequence below is designed to prevent an asymmetry in which the preferred design receives iterative engineering while the lower-impact design is dismissed from a sketch. Every gate should generate a disclosed deliverable, a reviewer, and a disposition.

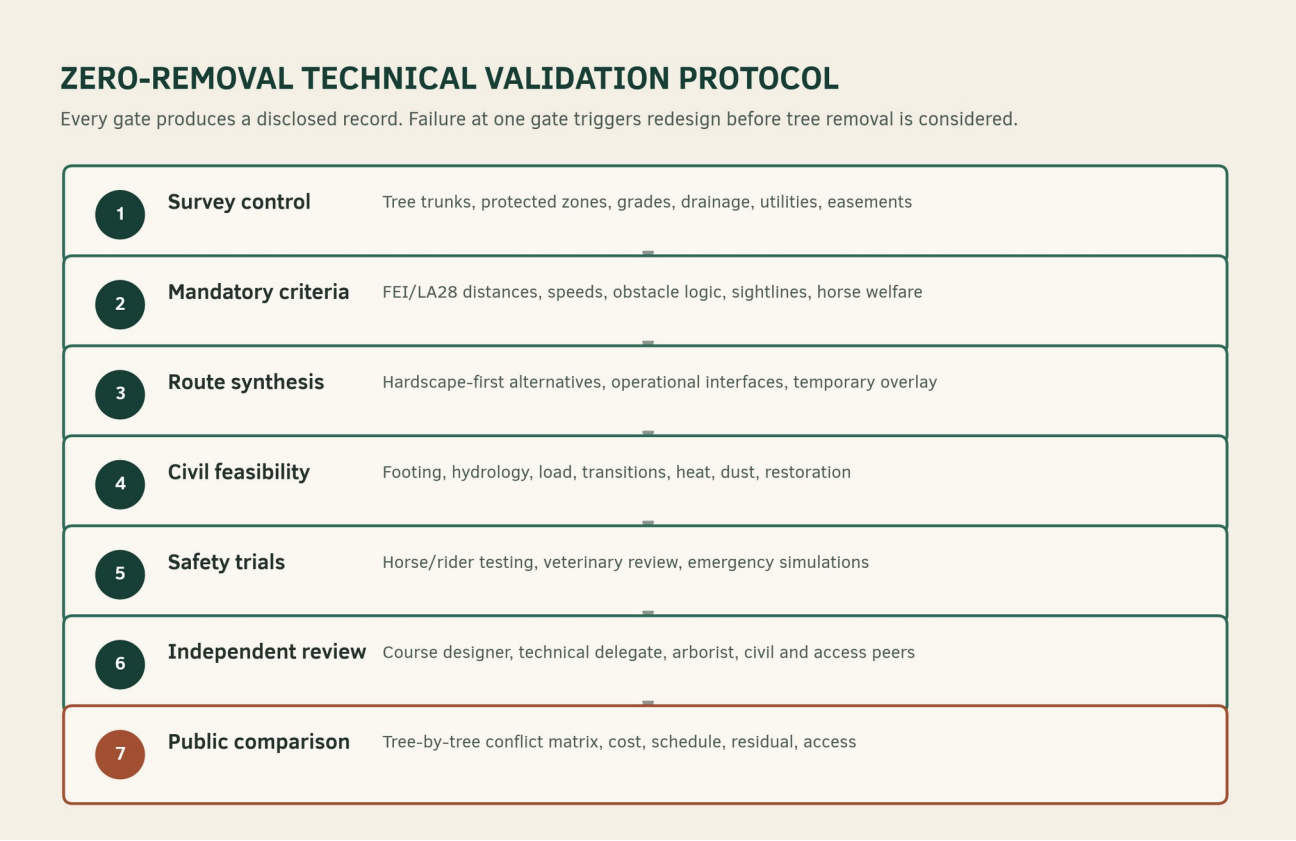



**FIGURE 3.** *Seven-gate validation protocol for a zero-removal alternative, from survey control through public comparison. A failure at any gate should trigger redesign and retesting before tree removal is considered.*

| Gate | Required analysis | Disclosed product |
|---|---|---|
| 1. Survey control | Certified survey of trunks, species, diameters, canopy, known roots, protected zones, topography, drainage, utilities, easements, paving, barriers, and existing equestrian assets. | A geospatial base file that all alternatives use. |

| Gate | Required analysis | Disclosed product |
|---|---|---|
| **2. Mandatory criteria** | Current FEI, LA28, veterinary, emergency, accessibility, broadcast, security, and venue-operating requirements, separated from preferences. | A criterion register with source, owner, mandatory status, and measurable threshold. |
| **3. Route synthesis** | At least three zero-removal variants and the selected proposal, generated against identical constraints. | Comparable plan sets and a design-decision log. |
| **4. Civil feasibility** | Footing, subgrade, drainage, transitions, loads, heat, dust, temporary works, utility protection, construction access, restoration, and lifecycle. | Signed civil and surface-engineering memorandum. |
| **5. Safety trials** | Horse and rider testing, veterinary review, emergency response simulation, course walk, heat and footing monitoring, and operational rehearsal. | Test protocol, data, incident log, and corrective actions. |
| **6. Independent review** | Course designer, technical delegate, equine welfare, civil, arboricultural, fire, accessibility, and operations review independent of the applicant's initial authors. | Peer-review letters and response matrix. |
| **7. Public comparison** | Tree impacts, cost, schedule, temporary and permanent works, residual value, access, and rejection reasons. | Published alternatives report supporting the City's findings. |

### Equal engineering effort is part of a fair comparison

Alternatives can be made to fail by starving them of iteration. If the selected route has been refined through months of meetings, survey work, obstacle design, grading, and operating consultation, a zero-removal alternative should receive a defined design sprint with access to the same information and decision-makers. The City should require a design log showing each issue, mitigation, retest, and final disposition. Only then can it distinguish an infeasible alternative from an underdeveloped one.

The independent review should also be structurally independent. A consultant who designed the preferred route can explain its rationale, but the City should retain or require a peer reviewer whose task is to challenge the necessity finding. The reviewer should be empowered to request alternate geometry, additional testing, and tree-specific evidence. The written response to that review should become part of the permit record.

SECTION 6

## Safety, welfare, and the required tree-specific conflict matrix

Human and equine safety is the strongest legitimate rationale available to the applicant. It is also a rationale that can be tested. The FEI has appointed Alec Lochore, an FEI Level 4 course designer and technical delegate, with Michael Etherington-Smith as advisor. FEI states that Lochore previously advised on cross-country feasibility at Santa Anita. [11] That expertise should be brought into the public record through criteria, measurements, design alternatives, and signed judgments, not through an unparticularized appeal to authority.

A tree may create a genuine conflict because of approach geometry, landing zone, sightline, speed, slope, horse escape line, ambulance corridor, or root-zone construction risk. The proper record should identify which conflict applies to which tree. If the conflict can be solved by moving a fence, rotating an approach, changing a sector, using a temporary crossing, redistributing course distance, or changing spectator and broadcast placement, the tree should remain. If it cannot, the report should show why.

### Template for the required conflict matrix

| Matrix field | Required entry |
|---|---|
| **Tree ID** | Surveyed identifier; species; trunk diameter; health; canopy; known roots. |
| **Protected geometry** | Mapped protected zone and the project element that enters it. |
| **Selected-course conflict** | Exact route, obstacle, grade, utility, access, or operational conflict. |
| **Mandatory criterion** | FEI, LA28, veterinary, fire, civil, accessibility, or other requirement, with source and threshold. |
| **Alternatives tested** | Route shifts, obstacle changes, temporary works, hardscape transfer, reduced overlay, or other mitigation. |
| **Residual failure** | Measured reason the mitigation fails and consequence if accepted. |

| Matrix field | Required entry |
|---|---|
| **Independent disposition** | Named reviewer, discipline, conclusion, conditions, and date. |
| **City finding** | Why removal or encroachment is more desirable than the tested alternatives for this tree. |

The same structure should cover the 45 encroachments. Root-zone impacts can be delayed, cumulative, and difficult to attribute after construction. A project that avoids cutting a trunk but compacts, excavates, paves, stores material, or changes grade within the root system can still produce loss. The matrix should therefore distinguish direct removal, temporary encroachment, permanent encroachment, and predicted post-construction risk.

> **SAFETY MUST BE AUDITABLE**
>
> The question is not whether safety matters. The question is whether the applicant can identify the mandatory safety requirement that conflicts with each protected tree after lower-impact geometry and temporary-overlay mitigation have been tested.

SECTION 7

# The 45 encroachments and construction controls

The removal count attracts attention, but TRE 26-09 may expose more trees to construction risk. Arcadia's regulations define encroachment broadly and require protection against building, impervious paving, storage, excavation, grade change, and other activity inside protected zones. The minimum zone extends 15 feet from the trunk and must include known root structure. [2] The 45 affected trees therefore require a construction-control program detailed enough to survive contractor mobilization, staging, weather, schedule pressure, and post-event restoration.

## Required root-zone protection plan

| | |
|---|---|
| 1 | **Survey and fencing**<br>Install surveyed, continuous protective fencing before mobilization. The protected area should reflect known roots and arborist direction, not only a generic radius. |
| 2 | **No-storage and no-parking enforcement**<br>Prohibit vehicles, spoil, containers, generators, fencing stock, obstacle components, chemicals, and worker parking inside protected zones. Assign inspection responsibility and penalties. |
| 3 | **Temporary crossing design**<br>Where a crossing is unavoidable, require arborist- and engineer-approved load distribution, aeration, edge treatment, monitoring, and immediate removal after use. |
| 4 | **Grade and drainage controls**<br>Prohibit unreviewed cuts, fills, trenching, water concentration, ponding, soil burial, and drainage redirection. Model both construction and event conditions. |
| 5 | **Dust, heat, and irrigation**<br>Protect foliage and root moisture through a documented watering, dust control, heat response, and soil-monitoring plan. |
| 6 | **Monitoring and stop-work authority**<br>Provide an independent arborist with site access, inspection cadence, photo logs, and authority to stop work when controls fail. |
| 7 | **Long-tail accountability**<br>Require multi-year health monitoring, replacement of any tree that declines because of project activity, financial security, and public reporting. |

These controls should be costed as part of each alternative. A route that nominally saves a tree but requires repeated heavy encroachment may be worse than a route that stays outside the protected zone. Conversely, a carefully engineered temporary crossing may be preferable to permanent grading and removal. The comparison should be based on predicted survival, construction risk, lifecycle, and restoration, not only on a binary “removed or retained” count.

### Tree survival should be a permit outcome, not a construction assumption

The permit should define performance standards. Those standards should include preconstruction vigor, soil and moisture baselines, canopy and root observations, construction inspection, event-period monitoring, post-removal soil restoration, annual arborist assessments, and a public record of mortality or decline. If a retained tree fails because of approved encroachment, the project should not be allowed to treat the loss as an unrelated future condition.

SECTION 8

## Permanent residual value, funding, ownership, and public access

Santa Anita has stated that the cross-country course will remain after the Games and will allow the property to invite more types of horse sport. [4] That is an express statement of residual operating value. It aligns with 1/ST's preexisting investment in show arenas and its stated objective of transforming the infield into a world-class equestrian venue. [6] The permit therefore affects more than event delivery. It participates in the creation of a permanent private sporting platform.

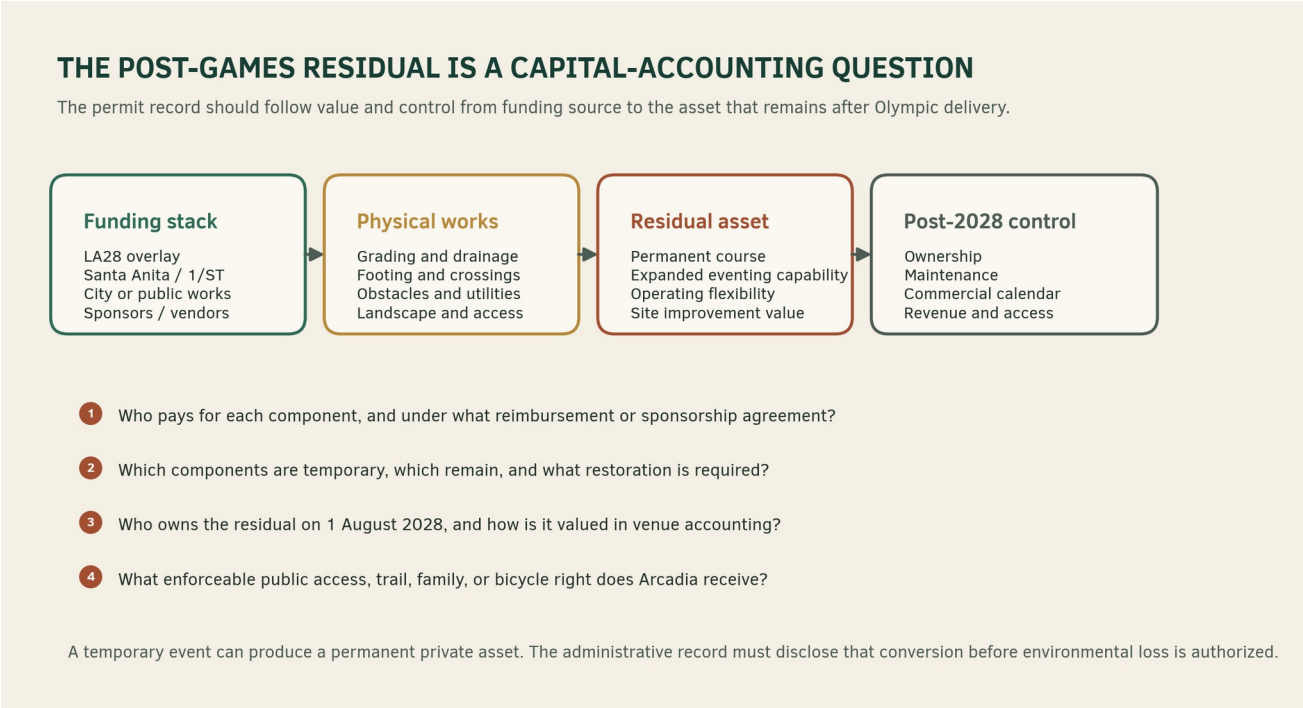



**FIGURE 4.** *Residual-asset ledger. The permit record should trace funding into physical works, identify which works remain, and disclose ownership, maintenance, commercial use, revenue control, and public access after the Games.*

### The complete capital stack should be disclosed

The record should identify every source that pays for grading, drainage, footing, obstacles, utilities, roads, barriers, landscape, stabling, temporary structures, restoration, and maintenance. It should distinguish LA28 expenditure, Santa Anita/1/ST capital, sponsorship or vendor contribution, City or public infrastructure expenditure, reimbursement, and in-kind support. The objective is not to characterize every public expenditure as a subsidy. The objective is to make the allocation visible.

Each physical work should then be classified as temporary, permanent, or convertible. Temporary works should have removal and restoration obligations. Permanent works should have an owner, useful life, maintenance plan, operating purpose, and valuation. Convertible works should identify who elects to retain them and who pays the incremental retention cost. Any agreement that allocates post-Games revenue, event dates, sponsorship inventory, maintenance, or restoration should be included.

### Public access is presently a question, not an identified right

Santa Anita is privately controlled and admits the public for races, tours, horse shows, festivals, and other programmed uses on its terms. Its current visitor information prohibits bicycles inside the park. [9] This review identified no published easement, trail dedication, public-use covenant, family walking right, bicycle right, or recurring free-access schedule attached to the proposed permanent course. That does not prove no access commitment exists in an undisclosed agreement. It does mean residents should not be told that a permanent "legacy" asset is a public amenity without a binding instrument.

The practical family question should be answered in writing: after Arcadia authorizes protected-tree loss and the Olympics leave, may an Arcadia resident enter the course with children for an ordinary walk, ride a bicycle through it, or use it without purchasing admission to a privately programmed event? If the answer is no, the City should describe the public benefit accurately. Economic activity, prestige, and occasional ticketed access may still be asserted benefits, but they are not a public right to the improved land.

> **RESIDUAL CONTROL QUESTION**
>
> Who owns the physical and commercial residual on 1 August 2028, who paid to create it, and what enforceable right does an Arcadia family receive in exchange for the irreversible environmental authorization?

SECTION 9

# Replacement accounting and ecological time

The City project page identifies 34 removals and 34 new trees. [1] Arcadia's tree-preservation regulations state a default minimum of two new 24-inch-box trees for each protected tree approved for removal, while allowing the Director to modify, waive, increase, or reduce the replacement requirement. [2] Thirty-four removals therefore begin from a default of 68 replacement trees. If the City intends to approve 34, the administrative record should identify the applicant's request, the official exercising modification authority, and the written basis for the reduction.

Replacement count is only the first layer of mitigation. Mature oaks provide canopy, shade, habitat, carbon storage, stormwater moderation, landscape identity, and root systems that cannot be reproduced at planting. A young nursery tree may be a valid mitigation component without being a current functional equivalent. The record should therefore include species, container size, planting location, irrigation, establishment period, mortality replacement, long-term maintenance, projected canopy, habitat assumptions, and time to defined performance milestones.

## A mitigation ledger should carry time and risk

| Ledger component | Required disclosure |
|---|---|
| **Immediate loss** | Canopy area, shade, habitat structure, trunk and root biomass, soil function, and landscape character removed at construction. |
| **Replacement input** | Species, number, nursery size, genetics or provenance, planting site, soil volume, irrigation, and protection. |
| **Performance curve** | Expected survival, canopy growth, water demand, habitat development, and years to specified thresholds. |
| **Failure security** | Bond, escrow, warranty, replanting obligation, maintenance entity, inspection, and enforcement. |
| **Residual gap** | The quantified period and functions for which the replacement planting does not equal the removed mature trees. |

Mitigation should also be compared across alternatives. A zero-removal route may require temporary pavement restoration, surface replacement, or additional overlay cost. The selected route may require permanent tree loss and replacement planting. The City should compare the full lifecycle, including ecological delay and failure probability, rather than treating a one-for-one planting count as closure.

SECTION 10

# LA28's no-permanent-build classification question

LA28 describes a venue-delivery program built around existing venues, temporary facilities, and temporary overlays. Its partnership materials refer to a no-new-permanent-venues or no-permanent-build approach and a temporary overlay and construction program exceeding $1 billion. [12, 13] Santa Anita is unquestionably an existing venue, so the existence of a permanent course does not automatically prove that LA28 has built a wholly new venue. The serious question is how the permanent course is classified within that accounting.

The public record should separate the existing venue from the new work. A new cross-country route may include temporary obstacles, temporary footing, permanent grading, permanent drainage, roads, utilities, landscape changes, and operational infrastructure. Some components may be ordinary maintenance or venue adaptation. Others may be new permanent capital improvements retained by the private owner. The classification should be component-specific and tied to funding, ownership, and useful life.

### A classification schedule

| Classification | Illustrative content |
|---|---|
| **Existing base asset** | Land, racing tracks, turf, grandstand, barns, veterinary clinic, parking, infield, arenas, utilities already in service before the project. |
| **Temporary Olympic overlay** | Rental equipment, barriers, tents, seating, temporary power, communications, portable obstacles, removable footing, ground protection, and temporary compounds. |
| **Permanent Olympic-triggered work** | Any grading, drainage, road, utility, footing, landscape, or course element constructed for Games requirements and retained afterward. |
| **Private elective enhancement** | Work selected to increase post-Games commercial capability beyond the minimum Games requirement. |
| **Restoration obligation** | Work required to return affected areas to the pre-project condition or another approved condition after the Games. |

This schedule would allow LA28 to preserve the legitimate distinction between adapting an existing venue and constructing a new one, while preventing permanent work from disappearing inside the word "overlay." It would also allow Arcadia to evaluate whether the environmental impact is proportional to the public event requirement or driven in part by a private legacy objective.

SECTION 11

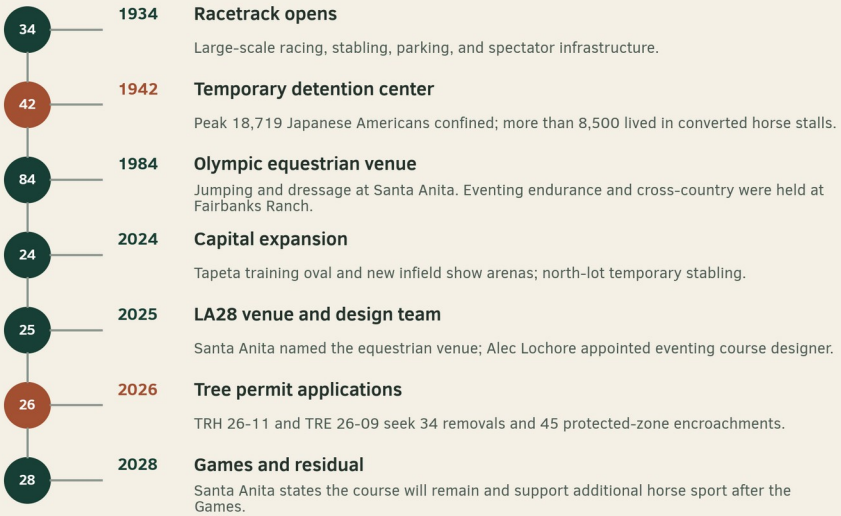
## Site history and institutional adaptability

Santa Anita's history supplies evidence of institutional adaptability, but it must be used with care. The site was converted in 1942 into a temporary detention facility for Japanese Americans. Densho records a peak population of 18,719 and reports that more than 8,500 people were confined in converted horse stalls. [17] That history should not be reduced to a clever comparison with Olympic construction. It describes a grave act of state coercion against a targeted population.

The limited planning inference is that controlling institutions have repeatedly reorganized this large property at exceptional scale when they considered adaptation a priority. The property later hosted Olympic equestrian events in 1984, although the eventing endurance and cross-country phase was staged at Fairbanks Ranch rather than at Santa Anita. Recent investments in the Tapeta oval and infield arenas provide a modern example of deliberate site adaptation. [6, 8]

### SANTA ANITA: REPEATED INSTITUTIONAL ADAPTATION

The history is relevant to site adaptability. It is not a substitute for modern civil, sporting, environmental, or welfare analysis.




The record supports one narrow inference: this 320-acre property has repeatedly absorbed major institutional programs when the controlling actors prioritized adaptation. That makes a formal hardscape-first study reasonable; it does not prove any particular route.

**FIGURE 5.** *Santa Anita timeline. The history shows repeated institutional adaptation of a large site. It does not prove that any specific zero-removal route satisfies current FEI, civil, welfare, environmental, or operational requirements.*

### The historically accurate campaign line

A defensible public statement is that Santa Anita was rapidly converted to confine nearly 19,000 Japanese Americans in 1942 and today operates as a 320-acre equestrian and event complex. The site's history and present capacity make it reasonable to demand evidence that a few days of Olympic cross-country cannot be delivered through a lower-impact configuration. The inaccurate claim that Santa Anita itself housed 100,000 people should not be used; the much larger number applies to the national forced-removal system, not this facility.

The history should widen the moral map without replacing the permit analysis. The City's duty arises from its own tree rules. The design question remains whether the present institutions will use their considerable technical and capital capacity to move the course before they move protected trees.

SECTION 12

## Arcadia-wide land-use context

The oak-tree dispute sits inside a city experiencing intense entitlement and infrastructure pressure, but the phrase "20 years of population explosion" is not supported by the municipal Census data. Arcadia counted 56,364 residents in 2010 and 56,681 in 2020. The July 2025 estimate was 54,117, approximately 4.5 percent below the 2020 estimate base. [14] The population record is essentially flat and recently declining.

The current friction is better described as regulatory and capital intensity. Arcadia has had to bring its housing element into state compliance, accommodate a Regional Housing Needs Allocation, rezone land, increase allowable densities in multiple districts, and process a concentrated project pipeline. The City's April 15, 2026 pipeline lists six projects totaling 1,206 residential units plus 17 live/work units at different approval and construction stages. [15, 16] A relatively stable population can still experience sharp land-use conflict when new entitlements, infrastructure programs, state mandates, and large private investments arrive in concentrated places and timeframes.

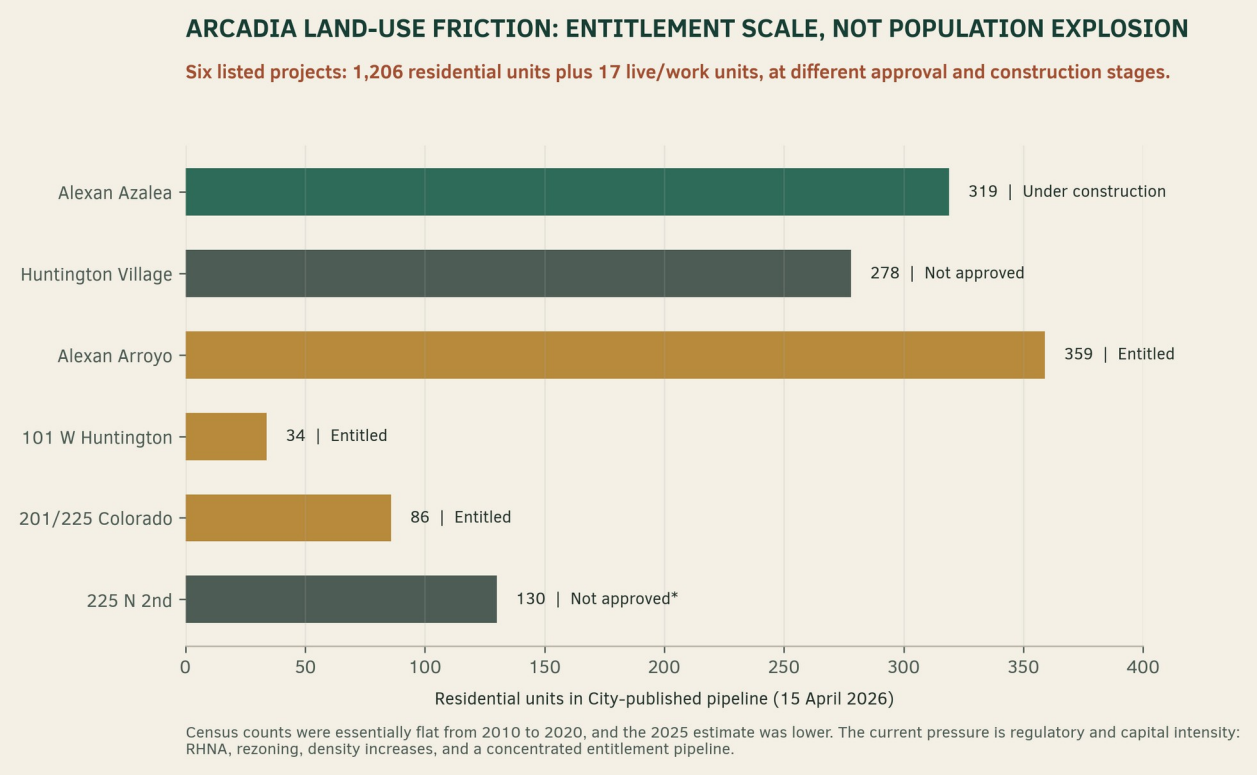



**FIGURE 6.** *City-published housing pipeline as of 15 April 2026. The pressure is a concentrated entitlement and capital program, not a two-decade municipal population explosion.*

## Why the wider map matters

A city under simultaneous housing, transportation, Olympic, and development pressure can normalize exceptions because each project arrives with its own schedule, consultant team, and asserted urgency. Protected-tree rules are meant to create a durable decision hierarchy across those cycles. Requiring a comparative alternatives record for Santa Anita is therefore larger than one permit. It tests whether Arcadia's environmental rules remain operative when a prestigious deadline and a powerful private venue converge.

The wider development map should be used to understand capacity and governance, not to manufacture a conspiracy. Each project has distinct ownership, financing, approval status, and legal posture. The useful institutional question is whether Arcadia has enough staff independence, public-record discipline, and appellate integrity to process multiple high-value programs without allowing preferred outcomes to become substitute findings.

> **CORRECTED CONTEXT**
>
> Arcadia's recent tension is produced by state housing mandates, rezoning, density changes, major entitlement pipelines, infrastructure demands, and Olympic delivery pressure. The Census record does not show a 20-year population explosion.

SECTION 13

# Actors, authority, and the decision path

The project is governed by four actor groups with different control. Santa Anita/1/ST controls the private property, existing operations, and post-Games use. LA28 controls Games delivery, overlay, schedule, and relevant contracts. The FEI design team controls or advises on sporting criteria, course design, technical validation, and equine welfare. The City of Arcadia controls local tree permits, grading, environmental review, the administrative record, and appeals. A complete decision requires each actor to disclose the evidence it uniquely holds.




**FIGURE 7.** *Actor and authority map. Agency duties are institutional; individual officials are decision-makers, custodians, advisors, or appellate actors and do not necessarily owe separate personal replies.*

## City decision and appeal chain

Arcadia's Development Services Director, Lisa Flores, leads the department responsible for the initial permit review and decision. Planning Services Manager Fiona Graham and the Planning Division are the practical project-file and staff-analysis contacts. The Planning Commission is the first appellate and public-hearing body identified in the tree regulations, and the City Council is the further appellate and policy-accountability body. The City Manager coordinates administration, the City Attorney advises on legal sufficiency, and the City Clerk manages formal records channels. [2, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23]

The duty to respond is institutional. The City as an agency must process records requests and make permit decisions through its established procedures. Every named official does not necessarily owe a separate personal email. The reason to distribute the memorandum across the chain is to prevent compartmentalization: Planning should not treat residual agreements as outside

its file, the Clerk should not treat permit evidence as merely a Planning concern, and elected officials should not encounter the alternatives defect for the first time after an appeal is filed.

### Decision discipline

The initial decision should identify the complete record relied upon, respond to the zero-removal hypothesis, make findings for removal and encroachment, address replacement-ratio modification, state the environmental-review posture, and provide clear notice of appeal rights and deadlines. Any appeal body should review the actual record and the findings rather than rely on a staff summary of undisclosed technical work.

> **CONTROL QUESTION**
> Which actor owns the evidence needed to prove necessity, and which City official will refuse to make the finding until that evidence is public and testable?

SECTION 14

# Recommended findings and implementation schedule

### Recommended interim findings

| | |
|---|---|
| 1 | **The present public record is incomplete**<br>The principal linked map, arborist, biological, and grading files were not publicly accessible through the City project page during this review, and the published material does not present a complete comparative alternatives analysis. |
| 2 | **Necessity has not been demonstrated on the public record**<br>The fact that one earlier route affected more trees does not establish that the selected route is the least damaging reasonably feasible alternative. |
| 3 | **A zero-removal study is reasonable**<br>Santa Anita's scale, existing equestrian surfaces, infield arenas, parking hardscape, stabling, veterinary resources, and LA28 temporary-overlay model provide sufficient capacity evidence to require formal testing. |
| 4 | **The project has a permanent private residual**<br>Santa Anita has stated that the course will remain and expand the types of horse sport it can host, requiring funding, ownership, maintenance, commercial-use, and public-access disclosure. |
| 5 | **Replacement and encroachment require separate findings**<br>The apparent 34-for-34 replacement proposal should be reconciled with the default two-for-one rule, and the 45 encroachments require a tree-survival construction plan. |

### Ninety-day decision path

| Period | Required action |
|---|---|
| **Days 0–10** | Restore the linked technical files; publish a complete index; identify the decision-maker, environmental-review posture, anticipated date, and appeal process; preserve all responsive records. |
| **Days 0–20** | Issue the ZR-1 study scope; deliver survey, criteria register, operating constraints, and all prior alignments to the study team and independent reviewers. |
| **Days 21–45** | Generate at least three zero-removal variants; perform civil, arboricultural, sporting, welfare, emergency, access, and operations screening; document iterations. |
| **Days 46–60** | Conduct surface, horse/rider, emergency, and operational trials at an appropriate scale; complete independent peer review and applicant responses. |
| **Days 61–70** | Publish the alternatives report, tree-specific conflict matrix, residual-asset ledger, replacement findings, construction protection plan, and environmental materials. |
| **Days 71–90** | Provide at least 20 days of meaningful public and expert review; conduct a noticed hearing if required; issue a reasoned decision and clear appeal notice. |

The exact schedule can be adjusted to Olympic milestones, but sequence should not be reversed. A deadline does not convert an undisclosed preference into a necessary finding. If the Games program cannot tolerate a short, disciplined alternatives study on a permit involving 79 protected-tree impacts, the schedule risk should be assigned to the project proponents who selected and advanced the present design, not to the trees or the public review process.

## Final disposition

**ZERO-REMOVAL FIRST**

Do not approve TRH 26-11 or TRE 26-09 until the applicant has completed, disclosed, and independently validated a tree-exclusion alternative and the City has explained, tree by tree, why removal or encroachment is more desirable than the tested lower-impact designs. If ZR-1 fails, publish the falsification and advance the next-least-impact design. If it works, redesign the course.

*The controlling question for the permit record is this: What mandatory, disclosed, and independently verified technical requirement makes removal of these 34 protected oaks more desirable than a zero-removal route using Santa Anita's extensive existing equestrian surfaces, hardscape, and temporary-overlay capacity, and what permanent public right does Arcadia receive for the permanent privately controlled asset its permit would authorize?*

APPENDIX A

# RFP-ready scope for a zero-removal feasibility study

The following scope can be issued by Arcadia, LA28, Santa Anita, or an independent technical sponsor. It is written to produce a permit-grade comparison rather than a public-relations concept. The contracting entity should preserve consultant independence, require disclosure of assumptions, and prohibit destruction of interim alternatives or decision logs.

| | |
|---|---|
| 1 | **Task 1: Data room and baseline**<br>Collect the certified tree survey, arborist inventory, protected-zone geometry, biological resources, topography, grading, drainage, utilities, paving, property and easement limits, existing equestrian surfaces, track-operation calendars, emergency plans, and every prior course alignment. Produce a gap register within five business days. |
| 2 | **Task 2: Criteria register**<br>Compile all current mandatory FEI, IOC/LA28, equine welfare, veterinary, fire, emergency, accessibility, security, broadcast, civil, environmental, and venue requirements. For each criterion, identify the source, owner, mandatory or preference status, measurable threshold, and approved variance process. |
| 3 | **Task 3: Tree-exclusion model**<br>Create a geospatial model in which every surveyed protected zone is an immutable exclusion. Add separate layers for optional operational buffers, construction risk, utilities, drainage, spectator and broadcast zones, horse circulation, emergency access, and restoration. |
| 4 | **Task 4: Alternative generation**<br>Develop at least three materially different zero-removal routes and one minimum-impact fallback. Each route should test different distributions across hardscape, infield, arenas, turf, track, and temporary overlay while maintaining event-system operations. |
| 5 | **Task 5: Civil and surface design**<br>For each route, prepare preliminary grading, drainage, footing, transition, load, heat, dust, temporary-work, construction-access, utility-protection, and restoration concepts. Identify permanent work and temporary work separately. |
| 6 | **Task 6: Sporting and welfare review**<br>The appointed course designer, technical delegate, veterinary and welfare experts should review speed, distance, obstacle logic, sightlines, effort, recovery, footing, weather, and emergency response. Each rejection or required change must cite the controlling criterion. |
| 7 | **Task 7: Operational integration**<br>Test racing, training, stabling, jumping, dressage, workforce, logistics, security, spectator, broadcast, accessibility, neighborhood traffic, and emergency operations. Identify movable overlays and retained permanent works. |
| 8 | **Task 8: Field validation**<br>Construct representative footing transitions, hardscape overlays, turns, obstacle approaches, and emergency bypasses. Conduct monitored trials with qualified horse and rider teams, surface instrumentation, veterinary oversight, and documented corrective actions. |
| 9 | **Task 9: Comparative evaluation**<br>Score each alternative using identical disclosed metrics: protected-tree removal, protected-zone encroachment, predicted tree survival, welfare and safety, civil risk, cost, schedule, operational disruption, temporary and permanent work, residual value, public access, and restoration. |
| 10 | **Task 10: Public report**<br>Publish drawings, data, assumptions, test results, reviewer letters, response matrix, tree-specific conflict matrix, cost ranges, schedule, residual-asset ledger, and a clear recommendation. Deliver native geospatial, spreadsheet, and presentation files in addition to PDF. |

## Required consultant team

The team should include an FEI-qualified eventing course designer and technical delegate; equine veterinary and welfare specialists; civil, grading, drainage, geotechnical, and surface engineers; a certified arborist independent of the applicant's initial report; event operations, broadcast, security, accessibility, fire and emergency specialists; a cost estimator; a restoration specialist; and a public-record manager. The City should retain a separate peer reviewer or establish a review panel with no financial interest in construction of the selected route.

### Acceptance criteria

The study is complete only when every mandatory criterion is traceable, every alternative receives comparable design effort, each affected tree has a conflict disposition, all permanent works and residual rights are disclosed, and the public can reproduce the principal comparisons from the supplied data. A report that concludes "infeasible" without identifying the failed criterion, mitigation attempted, and reviewer should be rejected as nonresponsive.

APPENDIX B

## Disclosure and records schedule

This schedule is designed for voluntary publication and for a focused California Public Records Act request. The preferred outcome is a project data room organized by subject, with rolling updates and native files. Where a record is withheld, the City should identify the specific exemption and produce all reasonably segregable material. [24, 25]

| Record family | Requested records |
|---|---|
| **Course development** | Every course map, alignment, site plan, obstacle plan, grading plan, access plan, tree-impact plan, annotation, and superseded version. |
| **Alternatives** | Alternatives matrices, route studies, design narratives, meeting notes, rejection decisions, cost and schedule comparisons, and decision logs. |
| **Criteria** | FEI, LA28, welfare, veterinary, engineering, emergency, access, broadcast, spectator, security, cost, schedule, and legacy criteria used to select or reject designs. |
| **Trees and biology** | Certified tree inventory, condition and species data, protected zones, roots, canopy, biological resources, habitat assessments, photographs, mitigation, and monitoring. |
| **Civil and construction** | Topography, grading, drainage, utilities, geotechnical, footing, temporary works, staging, contractor access, restoration, and construction-protection plans. |
| **Safety and testing** | Course walks, risk assessments, veterinary reviews, horse/rider tests, emergency simulations, incidents, comments, revisions, and approvals. |
| **Funding and ownership** | Agreements, MOUs, budgets, estimates, reimbursement, sponsorship, in-kind support, procurement, insurance, ownership, maintenance, restoration, and useful-life terms. |
| **Legacy and access** | Post-Games operation, commercial calendar, revenue, public access, easements, trail or bicycle rights, community use, and retention or removal decisions. |
| **Environmental review** | CEQA studies, exemptions, notices, memoranda, biological and arboricultural review, agency comments, and environmental determinations. |
| **Decision and appeal** | Completeness determination, staff analysis, consultant review, findings, conditions, notice, appeal instructions, public comments, and decision communications. |

### Search locations and actors

The search should cover Development Services, Planning, Engineering, the City Manager, City Clerk, City Attorney to the extent disclosable, Public Works, Fire, and City consultants. External correspondents should include Santa Anita Park, 1/ST, LA28, FEI, appointed course designers and advisors, architects, civil and surface engineers, arborists, biologists, venue-infrastructure partners, contractors, and relevant sponsors or vendors. Search terms should include TRH 26-11, TRE 26-09, cross country, eventing, oak, protected zone, legacy, remain, permanent, post-Games, zero removal, alternative, redesign, funding, ownership, maintenance, access, restoration, and the names of the principal actors.

### Production standards

Records should be produced electronically on a rolling basis and, where practical, in the format in which they are maintained. Native spreadsheets, geospatial files, presentations, drawings, schedules, and email families with attachments are materially more useful than flattened screenshots. Plans should be provided at original available resolution. The City should identify a records coordinator, tracking number, determination date, estimated production schedule, and any proposed narrowing before treating a category as unduly burdensome. [24, 25]

APPENDIX C

# Accountability recipients

The list below identifies the current administrative, records, legal, and elected chain that should receive the memorandum. It does not assert that every individual owes a separate statutory reply. The agency duties are institutional, while the named people occupy positions that control the permit, file, legal advice, administration, appeal, or public accountability. [18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23]

| Name | Position | Channel | Reason for notice |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Lisa Flores** | Development Services Director | lflores@ArcadiaCA.gov | Initial permit authority and department head. |
| **Fiona Graham** | Planning Services Manager | fgraham@ArcadiaCA.gov | Project-file, staff-analysis, and Planning coordination. |
| **Linda Rodriguez** | City Clerk | lrodriguez@ArcadiaCA.gov | Records channel, official notice, routing, and municipal record. |
| **Dominic Lazzaretto** | City Manager | domlazz@ArcadiaCA.gov | Administrative coordination across departments and Games preparation. |
| **Michael J. Maurer** | City Attorney | Route through City Clerk | Legal sufficiency, findings, environmental review, disclosure, and appeal advice. |
| **Paul P. Cheng** | Mayor | CityCouncil@ArcadiaCA.gov | Council policy and further appellate accountability. |
| **David Fu** | Mayor Pro Tem | CityCouncil@ArcadiaCA.gov | Council policy and further appellate accountability. |
| **Michael Cao** | Council Member | CityCouncil@ArcadiaCA.gov | Council policy and further appellate accountability. |
| **Sharon Kwan** | Council Member | CityCouncil@ArcadiaCA.gov | Council policy and further appellate accountability. |
| **John Han** | Council Member | CityCouncil@ArcadiaCA.gov | Council policy and further appellate accountability. |

The Planning Commission should receive the complete memorandum through Planning@ArcadiaCA.gov because it is the first appeal body and a public forum for the record. The public-record request should be submitted through Arcadia's official portal or designated records channel and should be tracked separately from the policy email. [19, 24]

## Submission protocol

| | |
|---|---|
| 1 | **Create a fixed record**<br>Send the memorandum as a PDF attachment and retain the sent message, headers, attachment hash, and any portal confirmation. |
| 2 | **Separate the actions**<br>Identify the message as a formal permit objection, request for inclusion in the administrative record, request to defer action, and accompanying public-record request if included. |
| 3 | **Request routing confirmation**<br>Ask the City to identify the initial decision-maker, project planner, anticipated decision date, environmental-review status, and appeal deadline. |
| 4 | **Preserve appeal capacity**<br>Use a full name and reliable contact information, state the interest in the project, and calendar the appeal period from formal notice rather than from informal statements. |

APPENDIX D

# Source register and limitations

Sources were last reviewed on 29 August 2026. Titles below are linked to the source pages. The memorandum paraphrases rather than reproduces extended source text. Current officeholders, project status, and public-file availability should be rechecked immediately before filing because they can change.

[1] City of Arcadia, LA28 Cross Country Course Proposal. Official project page for TRH 26-11 and TRE 26-09, including the 34 removals, 34 replacements, 45 encroachments, and links to the technical record.

[2] City of Arcadia, Tree Preservation Regulations. Official regulatory text concerning necessity, alternative designs, replacement ratios, protected zones, and appeals.

[3] City of Arcadia, Protected Trees and Regulations. Official public explanation of protected oak thresholds and healthy-tree permit requirements.

[4] ABC7 Los Angeles, Arcadia residents push back on Santa Anita Park tree-removal plan. Meeting coverage reporting the safety rationale, an earlier higher-impact design, LA28's statement that no final path had been selected, and Santa Anita's statement that the course will remain and support more horse sport.

[5] FEI, Santa Anita Park Named as LA28 Equestrian Venue. Official facility description: 320 acres, 26,000-seat grandstand, 50,000-person infield, 61 barns, more than 2,000 horses, and on-course veterinary capacity.

[6] Santa Anita Park, Three New Horse Show Arenas Nearing Completion. Official 1/ST description of the 2024 infield arenas, temporary north-lot stabling, and strategy to create a world-class equestrian venue.

[7] Santa Anita Park, 2025-26 Media Guide. Published track and turf-course dimensions and historical venue information.

[8] Santa Anita Park, All-New Synthetic Tapeta Training Track Now Open. Official description of the six-furlong, $8 million all-weather training oval and its relationship to the one-mile main track.

[9] Santa Anita Park, Plan Your Visit. Current entry rules, property access conditions, prohibition on bicycles, 320-acre filming description, parking gates, and event-controlled access.

[10] Santa Anita Park, Events and Host Your Event. Official description of more than one million square feet of flexible indoor and outdoor event space.

[11] FEI, Alec Lochore Appointed as Eventing Course Designer for LA28. Official appointment of the FEI Level 4 course designer and Michael Etherington-Smith as advisor; confirms prior feasibility advice concerning Santa Anita.

[12] LA28, Autodesk Named Official Design and Make Platform. Official description of a more than $1 billion temporary overlay and construction program under a no-new-permanent-venues plan.

[13] LA28, Sunbelt Rentals Named Official Rental Equipment Partner. Official statement that venue delivery relies on temporary venues and temporary overlays on existing permanent venues.

[14] U.S. Census Bureau, QuickFacts: Arcadia city, California. Official population counts and estimates for 2010, 2020, and 2025.

[15] City of Arcadia, Affordable Housing Development Pipeline. City-published project pipeline updated April 15, 2026, including unit counts and entitlement status.

[16] City of Arcadia, Housing Element and Rezoning Update. City materials concerning RHNA, state compliance, rezoning, and increased residential densities.

[17] Densho Encyclopedia, Santa Anita temporary detention facility. Historical record of the 1942 detention facility, including peak population and use of converted horse stalls.

[18] City of Arcadia, Development Services. Current department leadership and Planning contact information.

[19] City of Arcadia, Planning Commission. Current commission structure, meeting process, and written-comment channel.

[20] City of Arcadia, City Council. Current elected membership, policymaking role, and consolidated Council email.

[21] City of Arcadia, City Manager. Current City Manager and administrative role.

[22] City of Arcadia, City Attorney. Current contracted City Attorney and correspondence route through the City Clerk.

[23] City of Arcadia, City Clerk and Elections. Current City Clerk contact and institutional records role.

[24] City of Arcadia, Public Records Request Portal. Official channel for California Public Records Act requests.

[25] California Legislative Information, Government Code section 7922.535. Statutory timing and determination requirements for California Public Records Act requests.

## Specific limitations

| Limitation | Effect on analysis |
|---|---|
| **Unavailable linked files** | The City project page listed a map, arborist report, biological report, precise grading plan, and rough grading plan, but the linked URLs returned 404 errors during this review. The memorandum does not claim that the underlying documents do not exist. |
| **Conceptual geometry** | ZR-1 is based on published facility descriptions and a conceptual capacity model. It does not depict surveyed tree locations, actual grades, utilities, drainage, or a certified course. |
| **Sporting criteria** | Current FEI and LA28 requirements should be supplied by the project team and applied by qualified professionals. This paper does not prescribe a final competition distance, speed, fence sequence, or footing specification. |
| **Public access** | The review found no published binding public-access instrument for the residual course and found that current visitor rules prohibit bicycles. An undisclosed or later agreement could change that result. |
| **Development nexus** | The paper identifies Arcadia's broader development pipeline for governance context. It does not attribute the Santa Anita tree permits to Trammell Crow or another developer without a verified documentary link. |
| **Historical use** | The 1942 detention history is included to describe institutional adaptation and moral context. It is not treated as a precedent that validates any present land-use action. |